



UNLIKELY ALLIES: Lalu Prasad Yadav, Sushil Kumar Modi and Nitish Kumar have joined hands against Raj

“ THE LANGUAGE USED BY RAJ AND THE ACTION RESORTED TO BY HIS SUPPORTERS ARE CLEARLY ANTI-NATIONAL. ”

LALU PRASAD YADAV, UNION RAILWAY MINISTER

VICTIM:
Dharamdev, a
migrant labourer
from Uttar
Pradesh was
pulled out of a
train and killed



politics of hate that has been unleashed in India's commercial capital.

It would be tempting to wonder how a petty tyrant and gangster like the young Thackeray could be allowed to hold the country's most cosmopolitan city to ransom. The answer is to be found in the political career of Raj's uncle Bal Keshav Thackeray, founder of the Shiv Sena,

which is best defined by the ancient credo—*saam* (communicate), *daam* (buy), *dand* (force), *bhed* (divide). Thackeray built his party by playing the Marathi *manoos* card over 40 years ago. While his son Uddhav has been busy imparting lessons on the merits of globalisation, for nephew Raj, who split from the Shiv Sena three years ago, the four principles are sacred testaments. After adopting a universal

political philosophy embodied in the MNS flag that has bands of saffron for Hindus, green for Muslims and blue for Dalits, he has quickly leapt to the final—divisive politics.

The results are more than encouraging, if the recent incidents of violence in Mumbai are an indication. While MNS has sowed the seeds of dissent between the

Marathis and 'outsiders', it's the unsuspecting man in a local train who got lynched even as a hate-ridden Bihari youth opened fire in a BEST bus. That's the kind of hatred Raj Thackeray and his MNS is spreading. The incident of October 28, when Dharamdev Rai, a migrant labourer from Gorakhpur district in Uttar Pradesh, was lynched by Marathi-speaking youths after a clash, has left the nation shocked. Just a day earlier, Rahul Raj, a 23-year-old Bihari youth from Patna, travelled all the way to Mumbai with the sole intention to avenge the attack on fellow Biharis by the MNS over the past one year. But after he opened fire and held 13 passengers hostage at Kurla, he was shot down by the police.

If a corporate parallel were to be drawn, what's happening in Mumbai and the Shiv Sena is akin to a battle for succession. An ailing patriarch, his son who is seen as a rank outsider and a street-smart nephew who believes he was the successor. Add to that the weak leadership in a state where